MISS JOO WRITES

Notes on Becoming

August

A gentle reflection journal for anyone learning
to put things down and return to herself.

2026

Dear one,

August made me notice how much I carry without always admitting it.

Being dependable can make me feel close to people, until I realize how little room there is for being known. Being useful is not the same as being understood, and I want to make room for both.

I have also been thinking about the parts of myself I edit to fit, and the places I keep choosing simply because they once held me. I can honor what those chapters gave me without forcing them to stay.

In Germany, surrounded by people who seemed more certain, I was reminded that confidence often catches up after we decide to show up. Being new to a room does not mean I have nothing to contribute.

So this month, I want to put down what was never mine to carry, make room for rest before I am empty, and return to myself. I do not have to earn the right to pause before I begin again.

With love,

Miss Joo

THIS MONTH'S REFLECTIONS

Blog Recap & Highlights

1. The Difference Between Being Needed and Being Known - August 4
2. The Parts of Myself I Changed to Fit In - August 11
3. When You Outgrow the Places That Once Held You - August 18
4. I Am Learning to Enter Bigger Rooms Before I Feel Ready - August 30

QUOTES TO SIT WITH

> Being useful is not the same as being known.
>
> Adapting should not require disappearance.
>
> I can be grateful for a chapter without living it again.
>
> Confidence can catch up after I choose to show up.
>
> I can put down what was never mine to carry alone.

GUIDED REFLECTIONS

Reflections for This Month

REFLECTION 1

What am I carrying?

Which responsibilities, expectations, or emotional roles have become heavier than I admit? What can I put down, share, or pause?

REFLECTION 2

Rest without earning it

When do I treat rest as something I must deserve? What would change if I let rest be a need rather than a reward?

REFLECTION 3

Being needed and being known

Where do I feel valued mainly for what I do? What would it look like to be supported, not only relied on?

REFLECTION 4

Return to myself

What parts of me have been quiet lately? Which ordinary things, people, or routines help me feel like myself again?

REFLECTION 5

Fill in the blanks

I am carrying too much of... _____ .

I feel most like myself when... _____ .

I have permission to put down... _____ .

Before the next chapter, I need... _____ .

CREATIVE ACTIVITY

The Carry / Keep / Release Map

You do not have to put everything down. Sort what you are carrying: what still matters, what can be shared, and what no longer needs to come with you.

WHAT I WANT TO KEEP

WHAT I AM READY TO RELEASE

WHAT WILL HELP ME RETURN TO MYSELF

GRATITUDE & INTENTIONS

What I'm Grateful For

Three small ways I was supported, softened, or able to pause.

1

2

3

A small sign of return I want to honor:

My intention for September:

I do not have to carry everything to prove that I care.
I can put some things down and still be someone who cares.

NOTES ON BECOMING, AUGUST

Miss Joo Writes

missjoowrites.com · @missjooo98